

How Restaurants Are Reinventing Pasta

OFF DUTY

WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND

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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Paramount Global** is wrestling with whether to settle President Trump's lawsuit against its CBS News unit, and how it might do so without exposing executives to future legal threats, such as accusations of bribery. **A1**

◆ **Birkin bag maker Hermès** reported higher sales for the final quarter of 2024, boosted by a strong performance in the Americas. **B9**

◆ **Johnson & Johnson's** halt of U.S. sales of a new heart-rhythm device because of safety concerns is hobbling a major strategic push. **B10**

◆ **Cocoa futures** have retreated some from their latest record reached in December, but they ended Friday about 85% higher than a year ago, more than three times the typical price over the last two decades. **B10**

◆ **Stocks finished the week** higher after a mixed Friday in which the S&P 500 fell short of a new record. For the week, the S&P, Dow and Nasdaq indexes gained 1.5%, 0.5% and 2.6%, respectively. **B11**

◆ **Buffett's** Berkshire Hathaway reduced its positions in several financial stocks in the fourth quarter, but didn't sell any Apple shares. **B11**

World-Wide

◆ **Russia's spy services** have a shadowy new unit taking aim at the West with covert attacks across Europe and elsewhere, Western intelligence officials say. **A1**

◆ **A U.S. Army helicopter** crew may not have heard an instruction from air-traffic control before colliding with a jet last month, according to the NTSB. **A3**

◆ **The Justice Department** asked a judge to dismiss the bribery case against New York City Mayor Eric Adams, after a standoff between career prosecutors and Trump appointees that prompted a wave of resignations. **A4**

◆ **A federal judge** ordered the Trump administration to temporarily lift a freeze on U.S. aid abroad, citing the shutdown's damaging effects on businesses and nonprofits. **A5**

◆ **A Russian drone** struck the Chernobyl Nuclear Power Plant, Ukraine said. **A7**

◆ **Vice President Vance** blasted European allies, accusing them of repressing free speech and ignoring the will of voters. **A7**

◆ **Hamas** said it would release the last living American-Israeli civilian held hostage in Gaza along with two other men on Saturday. **A8**

NOONAN  
Trump, Jackson and the politics of crisis **A13**

NOTICE TO READERS  
WSJ.com and WSJ.com mobile apps will publish throughout the holiday weekend. The print edition won't be published on Monday, Washington's Birthday (Presidents Day).

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## Eagles Feel the Brotherly Love on Valentine's Day



**GREEN DAY:** Philadelphia fans turned out Friday as MVP quarterback Jalen Hurts and the Eagles celebrated their Super Bowl LIX victory with a parade through the City of Brotherly Love. The Eagles defeated the Kansas City Chiefs 40-22.

# How Trump Got GOP Senators To Get to 'Yes' on His Cabinet

By JOSH DAWSEY  
AND LINDSAY WISE

WASHINGTON—Inside a large room at the Republican National Committee's Capitol Hill headquarters, senators, longtime Trump operatives and business executives spent hours preparing an unconventional set of cabinet choices for grueling confirmation hearings.

Meanwhile, Republican activists and donors were making thousands of calls to senators' offices, pressuring them to cast yes votes. And Trump's nominees themselves were striking unusual deals with vacillating senators, leading to dramatic encounters, sometimes minutes before key votes.

Trump has assembled one of the most unorthodox cabinets ever, including two former Democrats and several ex-talk-show hosts. His team has pushed almost all of them through the Senate—often on tight, party-line votes—using a

mix of wooing and pressuring lawmakers, striking backroom deals and enlisting Republican senators to ensure that previously inexperienced nominees were prepared for public hearings, according to more than a dozen people involved in the process.

Defense pick Pete Hegseth faced allegations of excessive drinking and sexual assault, which he denied; Trump's selection for the top health post, Robert F. Kennedy Jr., has long

questioned vaccines; his choice to lead the intelligence community, Tulsi Gabbard, had appeared to embrace Washington's adversaries and celebrated past intelligence leaks. His nominee to run the Federal Bureau of Investigation, Kash Patel, had previously advocated investigations into people Trump considered his enemies.

**◆ DOJ asks judge to dismiss Adams case..... A4**

Some executives involved in the merger see settling the suit, which is focused on how CBS edited a "60 Minutes" interview with former Vice President Kamala Harris, as a way to alleviate tensions with the Trump administration.

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## Chefs Say No Thanks To Michelin Star Rating

By CHRISTINA CACOURIS

Last fall, the restaurant Giglio in Lucca, Italy, made a surprising request: to have its Michelin star removed from the 2025 guide.

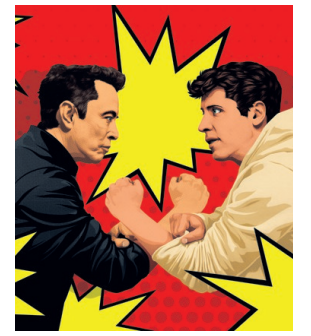
The Tuscan eatery had been awarded the star in 2019 for its traditional Italian food with a modern flair, such as potatoes with squid sauce, chanterelles and spicy parsley. Then came new clientele with heightened expectations. The owners, who desired a more relaxed environment, had come to think of the award as a burden.

"Such recognition represents the highest achievement a young chef can aspire to," said Stefano Terigi, a chef at Giglio. "We didn't have time to figure out if it was truly our path; we didn't seek it out."

For more than a century, the Michelin Guide has functioned as a culinary lodestar for chefs the world over, bringing them international customers and fame that has led to cookbooks, kitchen products and more. The French tire-company's guides have expanded across the world, creating yearly regional guides listing top-notch dining spots as determined by the company's anonymous taster-testers. Now, some chefs have said the prestigious award can become a gilded cage for res-

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## EXCHANGE



**BROMANCE TO BRAWL**  
The inside story of how Elon Musk and Sam Altman became such bitter enemies. **B1**

# Russian Spy Unit Spreads Violence, Sabotage in West

By BOJAN PANCEVSKI

Russia's spy services have a shadowy new unit taking aim at the West with covert attacks across Europe and elsewhere, Western intelligence officials said.

Known as the Department of Special Tasks, it is based in the Russian military-intelligence headquarters, a sprawling glass-and-steel complex on the outskirts of Moscow known as the aquarium. Its operations, which haven't

been previously reported, have included attempted killings, sabotage and a plot to put incendiary devices on planes. The department's creation reflects Moscow's wartime footing against the West, the officials said. It was set up in 2023 in response to Western support for Ukraine and includes veterans of some of Russia's most daring clandestine operations in recent years, according to two European intelligence chiefs and other U.S., European and Russian security officials.

The Kremlin sees the West as complicit in Ukraine's attacks on Russia such as the sabotage of the Nord Stream pipelines, the killings of senior officials in Moscow, and Ukrainian strikes using long-range Western missiles, according to these officials. Ukraine has denied it was behind the sabotage of the Nord

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## Bribery Worries Shadow Trump, CBS Suit

Paramount executives fear liability from a potential settlement paid before a merger

By JESSICA TOONKEL

Paramount Global is wrestling with whether to settle President Trump's lawsuit against its CBS News unit, and how it might do so without exposing executives to future legal threats, such as accusations of bribery.

Company executives in recent weeks have talked about the risk that paying such a settlement could expose directors and officers to liability in potential future shareholder litigation or criminal charges for bribing a public official, according to people familiar with the conversations. Some executives have expressed an additional concern that such litigation might not be protected by director and officer insurance, some of the people with knowledge of the discussions said.

Paramount is awaiting regulatory approval for its merger with Skydance Media. Some executives have flagged the potential risk that if the company settles and the deal is approved in short order, the payment could be construed as a bribe, the people familiar with the matter said.

Some executives involved in the merger see settling the suit, which is focused on how CBS edited a "60 Minutes" interview with former Vice President Kamala Harris, as a way to alleviate tensions with the Trump administration.

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## An American Retiree Lost at Sea Drifts From Bad to Worse

Eric Arthur was living large aboard a catamaran when his fortunes sank

By KEJAL VYAS  
AND PATRICIA GARIP

Talk about living the dream. Eric Arthur was 62 years old, retired, financially secure and, for the past four years, sailing carefree around the Mediterranean in his catamaran.

In December, the lifelong sailor who grew up in Los Angeles embarked on what became his greatest adven-

ture. It began with a crossing of the Atlantic. He had bought his 48-foot catamaran in Greece and gave it his own nickname, the Tambo, a mashup of the 1980s movie characters the Terminator and Rambo.

Arthur, described by friends as an affable thrill-seeker, completed his trans-Atlantic voyage and celebrated the New Year's

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